



Alaska

LIVING IN THE NORTHERNMOST PART OF THE US

THE ARCTIC IS AN UNLIKELY PLACE FOR MAN TO LIVE. The extreme weather and temperature conditions make it very difficult to survive there. Thousands of years ago the Inuit people mastered the art of survival in the cold and learned to live successfully off the land. Life for the Inuit, however, started to change following the purchase of Alaska by the US in 1867. In the 20th century, technology made it possible for others to live comfortably in Alaska, and people started to arrive when it was discovered that the area was rich in natural oil and gas as well as gold. The oil and mining companies moved in and the trans-Alaska oil pipeline—which carries millions of gallons of oil every day across the country—was built. The challenge for the Alaskan people today is to reclaim their cultural identity as well as move forward in the modern world. The clash continues over oil retrieval and the preservation of the polar environment.